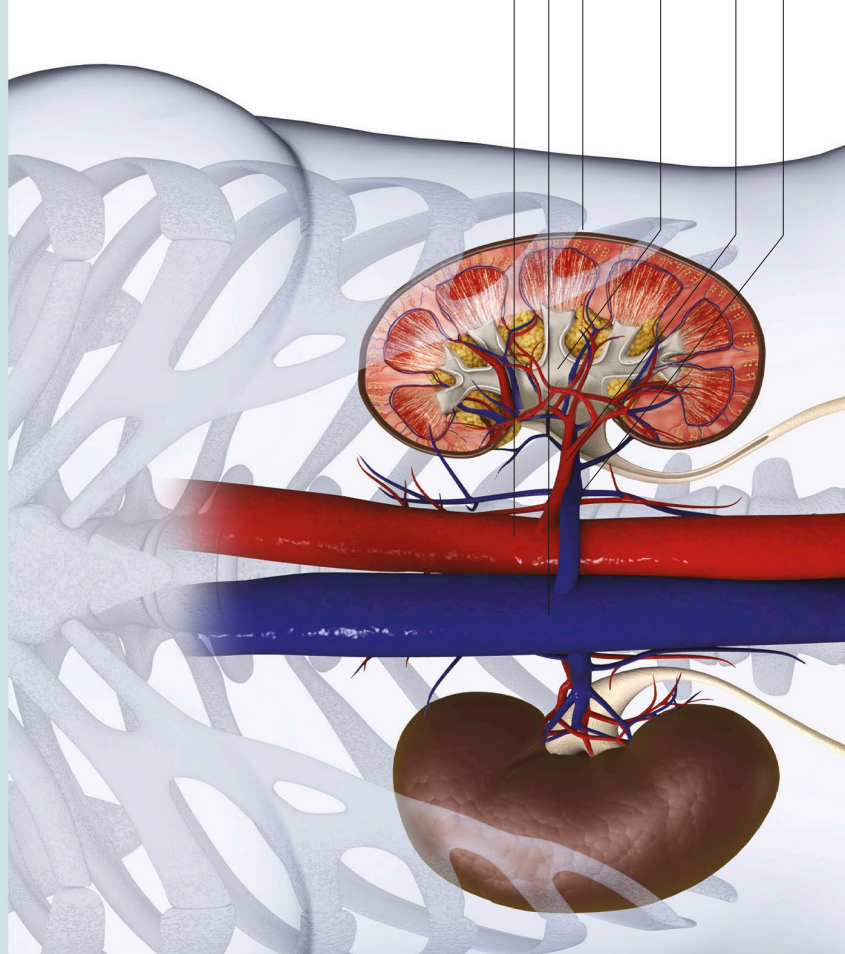


URINARY ANATOMY

THE URINARY SYSTEM IS COMPOSED OF TWO KIDNEYS, TWO URETERS, A BLADDER, AND A URETHRA. IT REGULATES THE VOLUME AND COMPOSITION OF BODY FLUIDS AND EXPELS WASTE AND EXCESS WATER FROM THE BODY.

The two kidneys are reddish organs resembling beans in shape. They are situated on either side of the abdomen, just above the waist and towards the back of the body. Each kidney contains many microscopic filtering units that remove unwanted waste, minerals, and excess water from the blood as urine. A ureter transports the urine to the bladder, which gradually becomes spherical, then pear-shaped, as it fills up. Eventually, stretch receptors in the bladder wall initiate a conscious desire to urinate. The urethra then conducts urine from the bladder to the outside.



Aorta

Inferior vena cava

Kidney

Each is about 10–12.5cm (4–5in) long, and contains about 1 million filtering units

Renal pelvis

Funnel-shaped chamber in which urine collects before passing down the ureter

Renal artery

Renal vein